

PROJECT CONCEPT NOTE

Clarity AI — Socratic AI Coach & Cognitive Reflection Assistant

Project Title:	Clarity AI Socratic Coaching Platform
Application Name:	Clarity AI
Live AWS URL:	http://clarity-ai-app.us-east-1.elasticbeanstalk.com
Author / Presenter:	Abhilipsa Nayak
LLM Engine:	Google Gemini API (gemini-2.0-flash / REST Transport)

Problem Statement & Objective

In the modern workspace, individuals suffer from constant choice fatigue and cognitive overload. With the emergence of direct AI chatbots, users tend to outsource their critical decision-making processes. This creates cognitive passivity and reduces deep personal reflection. The objective of Clarity AI is to scale Socratic coaching methodology, helping users dissect their assumptions, identify cognitive blind spots, and formulate immediate next steps that match their values.

Target User & Use Case

Target Users: Professionals, software developers, leaders, and students facing decision fatigue, burnout, or career dilemmas.

Primary Use Cases:

- **Career Decisions:** Dissecting dilemmas (e.g., job changes, project scopes) by separating internal objectives from external variables.
- **Burnout Mitigation:** Checking personal boundaries and recognizing physical/emotional stress patterns.
- **Conflict Reflection:** Analyzing interpersonal friction objectively rather than reacting emotionally.

LLM Model & API Configuration

Clarity AI utilizes the **Google Gemini API** (primarily **gemini-2.0-flash** and **gemini-2.0-flash-lite** as fallback) to drive its coaching interactions. Key technical details include:

- **REST Transport Protocol:** Configured to use REST instead of gRPC, preventing cloud

network container blocks.

- **Boundary Timeout:** Integrated a strict 5.0-second timeout limit to prevent backend thread hangs.
- **Offline Fallback Loop:** Catches rate limit (429) errors instantly and switches to mode-specific local coaching mocks.

Key Features

- ■ **Normal Mode:** Delivers direct, clear answers for standard factual queries.
- ■ **Reflect Mode:** Asks open-ended Socratic questions to encourage self-guided discovery.
- ■ **Focus Mode:** Gently highlights cognitive blind spots and control structures.
- ■ **Action Mode:** Guides users to build immediate, value-aligned small action items.
- ■ **Streak Gamification:** Tracks daily reflective sessions, awarding mindfulness ranks.

Expected User Experience & Outcomes

Users experience a premium, fluid SPA with zero navigation latency, dark mode default themes, and responsive design suitable for both desktop and mobile viewports. By engaging with Clarity AI regularly, users build structured thinking habits, lower stress, and make decisions with higher alignment and focus.